

WELCOME TO HǎO-SHUO-DE: THE QUANTUM CORE

1. The Problem: The Cognitive Wall

If you have ever thought about learning Mandarin Chinese, you have probably been told it is one of the hardest languages on Earth.

The difficulty isn't a myth, but it *is* misunderstood. Traditional language courses force you to attack four massive walls at the exact same time:

- **Thousands of complex characters** (Hanzi)
- **Unfamiliar tones and pronunciation**
- **An entirely foreign grammar system**
- **An overwhelming library of thousands of words**

When you try to memorize a massive dictionary while simultaneously learning how to structure a sentence, your brain runs out of processing power. You spend so much energy hunting for the specific word for "refrigerator," "employee," or "cat" that you never actually learn how to *think* in the language. You freeze up before you can even begin.

Hǎo-shuo-de changes the rules of the game.

2. The Solution: Radical Reduction

Hǎo-shuo-de (meaning "good speech") is based on a radical engineering question:

What is the absolute smallest number of words required to speak 100% grammatically correct, real Mandarin?

The answer is about **120 words**.

This idea was inspired by *Toki Pona*, a minimalist invented language created in 2014 by linguist Sonja Lang. Toki Pona proved to the world that you can express almost any human thought using a tiny toolkit of roughly 120 basic concepts. If you are hungry, you say "want eat". If you teach, you "give knowledge".

Hǎo-shuo-de steals that brilliant minimalist footprint but completely throws out the invented conlang elements. Instead, it routes those core concepts through **real, uncompromised, native Mandarin grammar**.

By freezing your vocabulary at just about 120 words, the exhausting chore of word-hunting completely vanishes. Your mind is freed to focus 100% of its energy on mastering native sentence structure, rhythm, and flow.

3. A Real Bridge, Not an Island

There are plenty of simplified or artificial languages out there, but they usually create a trap: you end up speaking a private code that only a small club of enthusiasts understands.

Hǎo-shuo-de is explicitly designed to avoid this. Every single sentence you build in Hǎo-shuo-de is **grammatically perfect, standard Mandarin**. Nothing you learn here will ever have to be unlearned. Because the grammar engine is 100% authentic, **any native Mandarin speaker on the planet will understand you**.

Because we are working with a tiny vocabulary, we use the clever, elegant structures built directly into native Chinese grammar to handle complex ideas. For example, to change the state of an object, we use the standard native Mandarin *bǎ* construction paired with *biàn* (to become or change):

Subject + *bǎ* + Object + *biàn* + State/Adjective

- **To break something** (Make a thing become bad): *Tā bǎ dōngxi biàn huài le.* (*Literally: He took the thing and made it become bad.*)
- **To cool down water** (Make water become cold): *Wǒ yào bǎ shuǐ biàn lěng.* (*Literally: I want to take the water and make it become cold.*)

4. The Rules of the Sandbox

To make your entry completely seamless, this book applies a few strict visual rules to protect you from cognitive overload:

- **Zero Characters:** The visual wall of Chinese characters is entirely stripped away. You will read and write exclusively using Pinyin—the standard, phonetic Latin alphabet for Chinese.
- **Explicit Word Boundaries:** Multi-syllable dictionary words are kept as solid blocks so you know they are a single unit (e.g., *dòngwù* for animal, *shuìjiào* for sleep).
- **Syntactic Hyphens:** Hyphens are used strictly to show how grammar particles and descriptions glue onto their targets (e.g., *zhè-ge* for *this one*, *hěn-dà-de* for *very big*).
- **The Quote Partition:** Any specialized foreign names or literal animal sounds are cordoned off in quotation marks (e.g., *jiào "wāng-wāng"* for *goes "woof woof"*) so your brain knows to skip looking them up in the vocabulary.

This is not a toy version of Chinese. It is the sophisticated, high-performance operating system of the language, stripped of all historical baggage. Master these 120 words, and you install the structural muscle memory of Mandarin directly into your brain.

Part 1: Lessons

Lesson 1: Letters and Sounds

Hǎo-shuo-de uses standard Latin Pinyin orthography to express real Mandarin words. Unlike languages with invented phonetic systems, Hǎo-shuo-de adopts standard Chinese dictionary tones.

This book doesn't teach you pinyin, so for more information please consult standard Chinese materials for beginners about pinyin, like HSK 1 or analogs.

Tones

Dictation forms always retain their standard baseline tones in writing, regardless of natural spoken flow:

- ā (First tone: high and level)
- á (Second tone: making a question/rising)
- ǎ (Third tone: dipping low then rising)
- à (Fourth tone: sharp and dropping)

Hyphenation Rules

To make the architecture of the language transparent, Hǎo-shuo-de separates vocabulary from grammar visually:

1. **Lexical words stay solid:** Multi-syllables that form a single dictionary word are never split (e.g., **dòngwù**, **shuǐjiào**, **dànshì**).
 2. **Syntactic units bind:** Hyphens are used strictly to glue grammatical particles, measure words, or description phrases to their targets (e.g., **zhè-ge**, **yī-ge**, **hěn-dà-de**).
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Lesson 2: Words and Sentences

Vocabulary

- **dōngxi** — thing, something, being
- **rén** — person, human
- **shuǐguǒ** — fruit, vegetable
- **xiě** — write
- **nǚrén** — woman, female
- **zhè** — this
- **dòngwù** — animal, land mammal

Grammar

To build a basic descriptive sentence in Hǎo-shuo-de, use the standard Mandarin **is/am/are** structure. You do not need to change the verb based on who is speaking:

Subject + shì + Noun

- **No Plurals:** By themselves, Hǎo-shuo-de nouns are completely number-neutral. Context dictates the volume. For example, the word **nǚrén** can mean either "woman" or "women" depending on the situation.
- **Pointing to Things:** To say "this" or "that," Hǎo-shuo-de links the demonstrative pointers (**zhè** or **nà**) directly to the universal measure word **gè** using a hyphen (**zhè-ge** / **nà-ge**).
- **Action-to-Noun Building:** In Mandarin, you can easily build nouns out of verbs by adding the particle **de**. Because Hǎo-shuo-de avoids cluttering your brain with separate specialized words for "book," "paper," or "document," these concepts are elegantly expressed as a compound unit meaning **"a written thing"** (**xiě-de dōngxi**).

Examples

- Zhè-ge shì rén. (This is a person.)
- Zhè-ge shì shuǐguǒ. (This is a fruit.)
- Yī-ge xiě-de dōngxi shì dōngxi. (A written thing [book/document] is a thing.)
- Rén shì nǚrén. (The person is a woman.)
- Dòngwù shì dōngxi. (Animals are things.)
- Nǚrén shì rén. (Women are people.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following sentences into Hǎo-Shuo-De rules (Answers below):

1. This is a document.
2. A woman is a human.
3. Animals are beings.

Answers to Exercise

1. Zhè-ge shì xiě-de dōngxi.
 2. Nǚrén shì rén.
 3. Dòngwù shì dōngxi.
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Lesson 3: Nouns and Adjectives

Vocabulary

- **shuǐ** — water, liquid
- **dìfāng** — a place (both in space or metaphorical to mean part of something).
- **xiǎo** — little, small
- **hǎo** — good, simple, friendly
- **dà** — big, important, tall

Grammar

An adjective can modify a noun directly by following standard predicate structure:

Subject + hěn + Adjective

When an adjective phrase directly modifies a noun as a single unit, it uses the structural particle **-de**.

Examples

- Shuǐ hěn hǎo. (Water is good.)
- Zhè-ge shì hěn-xiǎo-de dìfāng. (This is a small room.)

- **wǒ kàn yī-ge hěn-dà-de dòngwù.** (I see a very big animal.)
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Lesson 4: You and I

Vocabulary

- **wǒ** — I, me, we
- **nánrén** — man, male
- **nǐ** — you
- **qún** — community, group
- **xīn** — new, another, fresh
- **lìliang** — power, energy (used alongside *yǒu* to mean strong, confident, or dependable)

Grammar

Unlike Toki Pona, where pronouns drop specific structural elements, Hǎo-shuo-de functions completely within standard Mandarin grammar. Pronouns act as standard subjects and form possessive modifiers naturally by binding to the syntactic particle **-de** via a hyphen (e.g., **wǒ-de**, **nǐ-de**).

To express the adjective "strong," Hǎo-shuo-de leverages the native construction **yǒu lìliang** (to have power or strength).

Examples

- **Nǐ-de dìfāng hěn xīn.** (Your home is new.)
- **Nánrén shì hǎo-de rén.** (The man is a friend / a good person.)
- **Dòngwù-de dìfāng hěn xiǎo.** (The doghouse / animal's house is small.)
- **Nǐ shì yǒu-lìliang-de nánrén.** (You're a confident/strong man.)
- **Xīn-de qún hěn yǒu lìliang.** (The new community is strong.)
- **Zhè-ge shì nǐ-de zhǐ.** (This is your book / document.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. You are strong.
2. My community is large.
3. Fresh water is a good thing.

Answers

1. **Nǐ hěn yǒu lìliang.**

2. Wǒ-de qún hěn dà.
 3. Xīn-de shuǐ shì hǎo-de dōngxi.
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Lesson 5: Dòngzuò (Verbs)

Vocabulary

- **yǒu** — to have, contain, carry
- **tīng** — to listen to, hear, obey
- **chī** — to eat, drink, consume; food
- **zuò** — to make, do, work on
- **zhīdào** — to know
- **shuō** — to talk, speak, communicate;

Grammar

Hǎo-shuo-de eliminates Toki Pona's direct object marker *e* entirely by relying on standard Mandarin Subject-Verb-Object (SVO) word order.

Verbs do not change their forms to reflect past, present, or future tenses. Instead, aspect markers like the perfective particle **le** can be appended to show completed actions. Words fluidly shift roles depending on context—for instance, **chī** represents the action "to eat" or the noun "food," while **zhīdào-de rén** acts as "a knowledgeable person".

Examples

- Wǒ zhīdào hǎo shuō-de. (I know a simple language / good speech.)
- Nà-ge nánrén shì shuō-de rén. (That man is a messenger / speaking person.)
- Dà-de dòngwù zài chī nǐ. (A large animal is eating you.)
- Qún-de xiě-de dōngxi hěn hǎo. (The community's book is reliable.)
- Nǐ zuò le xīn-de chī. (You made new food.)
- Zhīdào-de rén tīng. (A person of knowledge listens.)
- Zhīdào-de dìfāng yǒu xiě-de dōngxi. (The school / house of knowledge has books.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. I will listen to you.
2. The woman obeyed the man.
3. The friends ate meat.

Answers

1. Wǒ tīng nǐ.
2. Nǚrén tīng le nánrén.
3. Hǎo-de rén chī le dòngwù.

Lesson 6: More Adjectives & State Changes

Vocabulary

- **bù** — not, no
- **huài** — bad, negative, broken
- **duō** — many, a lot, very
- **fùmǔ** — parent, ancestor
- **yī** — one, united

Grammar

Adjectives can modify other adjectives or verbs by preceding them directly as adverbs (e.g., **hěn duō** for "very many").

The Causative Rule

To turn an adjective into a transitive action (such as transforming "good" into "to fix/improve" or "bad" into "to break"), you must use the standard Mandarin **把 (bǎ)** construction paired with **变 (biàn — to become/change)**:

Subject + bǎ + Object + biàn + Adjective

Examples

- **Nǐ-de zuò-de hěn hǎo.** (Your work is very good.)
- **Shuǐ gěi wǒ lìliang.** (Water strengthens me / gives me energy.)
- **Zhīdào-de rén kàn xiě-de dōngxi.** (The scholars read the document / look at the paper.)
- **Xiǎo-de nǚrén méiyǒu hǎo-de tīng fùmǔ.** (The girls misheard / didn't listen well to the parent.)
- **Méiyǒu rén shì huài-de.** (Nobody is bad.)
- **Nánrén-de fùmǔ duō-de kàn xiě-de dōngxi.** (Fathers use/read the book a lot.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. The man doesn't eat bad fruit.

2. Eating makes me tall.
3. I know Hǎo-shuō-de a bit.

Answers

1. Nánrén bù chī huài-de shuǐguǒ.
 2. Chī bǎ wǒ biàn dà.
 3. hǎo-shuō-de, wǒ zhīdào-de bù duō.
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Lesson 7: Questions and Answers

Vocabulary

- **gōngjù** — tool, machine, device
- **yú** — fish, sea creature
- **tā** — he, she, it, they
- **huòzhě** — or
- **shénme** — what, which
- **wèishénme** - why
- **zenme** - how

Grammar

To ask a "what" or "which" question in Hǎo-shuō-de, you do not alter the sentence structure. Simply place the question word **shénme** directly into the syntactic position of the information you want to discover.

For yes-or-no questions, Hǎo-shuō-de completely bypasses Toki Pona's particle rules by adopting standard Mandarin grammatical structures:

1. **The ma Construction:** Append the question marker **ma** to the very end of a standard statement.
2. **The A-bù-A / A-méi-A Construction:** Reduplicate the main verb or adjective with the negative particle **bù** (or **méi** if using the verb **yǒu**).

To answer "yes," simply repeat the main verb. To answer "no," repeat the verb alongside its negative particle, or use **bù** / **méiyǒu** on its own.

Examples

- **Shénme shì xīn-de?** (What is new?)
- **Shénme rén zài shuō?** (Which person is speaking?)
- **Tā yǒu-méi-yǒu hěnduō-de shuǐguǒ?** (Does he have many vegetables/fruits?)
- **Yǒu.** (Yes. / He has.)

- **Nǐ tīng-bù-tīng fùmǔ?** (Do you obey your parents?)
- **Bù tīng.** (No. / I don't obey.)
- **Tā zài chī shénme?** (What is it eating?)
- **Nǐ gěi tā yú ma?** (Are you giving her a fish?)
- **Wèishénme nǐ gěi tā yú?** (Why you are giving her a fish?)
- **Nǐ zěnmē bǎ HAOSHUODE biàn zhīdào?** (How do you learn HAOSHUODE?)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. What tools do you have?
2. Does he listen?
3. Is the tool small?

Answers

1. **Nǐ yǒu shénme gōngjù?**
2. **Tā tīng-bù-tīng?** (or **Tā tīng ma?**)
3. **Gōngjù xiǎo-bù-xiǎo?** (or **Gōngjù xiǎo ma?**)

Lesson 8: Prepositions & Coverbs

Vocabulary

- **gěi** — to, for, give
- **zài** — at, in, present, existing
- **yòng** — using, with, by means of
- **yīnwèi** — from, because of

Grammar

In Hǎo-shuo-de, prepositions function exactly like standard Mandarin coverbs. They typically introduce a noun phrase and sit right before the main action of the sentence:

Subject + Coverb Phrase + Main Verb + Object

If no other action verb is present in the clause, the coverb itself steps up to serve as the main predicate of the sentence (e.g., **Wǒ zài dìfāng** — I am in the house).

Examples

- **Wǒ gěi tā yú.** (I give fish to her.)

- Wǒ zài dìfāng gěi tā yú. (I give fish to her in the house.)
- Wǒ zài dìfāng. (I am in the house.)
- Wǒ zǒu nǐ-de pángbiān. (I am moving towards you / going to your side.)
- Wǒ-de fùmǔ zǒu-dào hěn-dà-de shuǐ. (My parent is going to the sea / big water.)
- Yīnwèi zhè-ge, wǒ zuò le hěn duō. (Because of this, I worked a lot.)
- Wǒ yòng Hǎo-shuo-de shuō. (I speak in Hǎo-shuo-de / use Hǎo-shuo-de to speak.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. The worker uses tools.
2. He gives things from his house.
3. Why did you do it?

Answers

1. Zhè-ge gōngjù-de rén yòng gōngjù. (or Jié-gè rén yòng gōngjù.)
2. tā gěi lai-tā-de-difang-de dōngxi.
3. Weishénme nǐ zuò le zhè-ge?

Lesson 9: Proper Names & Geography

Vocabulary

- **fāngfǎ** — way, street, method, path
- **nǐ-jiào-de cí** — name
- **dǎ** — to fight, battle, compete against

Grammar

Unique external identities, such as specific regional locations or personal human titles, follow standard Mandarin phonetic spelling and capitalization rules.

Proper names are always enclosed within quotation marks.

In line with standard Chinese modifier syntax, proper names always behave as adjectives. This means they are placed directly **before** the generic baseline noun that identifies what kind of thing they are:

- "Name" + rén (The person named...)
- "Name" + fāngfǎ (The street/way of...)
- "Name" + dìfāng (The place/country of...)

Examples

- **Wǒ-de nǐ-jiào-de cí shì "Āpǔ".** (My name is Apu.)
- **"Āfēilìjiā" dìfāng yǒu hěn-duō rén.** (Africa has many people.)

Correction: Placed "Āfēilìjiā" before **dìfāng** to match standard Mandarin word order.

- **"Zhōngguó" nǚrén zǒu-dào nà-ge fāngfǎ.** (The Chinese lady is going to that street/way.)

Correction: Placed "Zhōngguó" before **nǚrén**.

- **"Bélín" dìfāng zài "Déguó" dìfāng.** (Berlin is in Germany.)

Correction: Both locations now use the correct proper name + baseline noun order.

- **Nǐ zhīdào-bù-zhīdào "Yīngyǔ"?** (Do you know English?)
- **"Sūlù" nánrén dǎ huài-rén.** (Mr. Sulu fights a bad guy.)

Correction: Placed "Sūlù" before **nánrén**.

- **Zhè-ge hěn-duō-rén-de-dìfāng hěn dà.** (This country is very large.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. Are you from Germany?
2. What is your name?
3. I am going to England.

Answers

1. **Nǐ shì-bú-shì "Déguó" dìfāng-de rén?**

Literal translation: "Are you a person of the Germany place?"

2. **Nǐ-de nǐ-jiào-de cí shì shénme?**

3. **Wǒ zǒu-dào "Yīngguó" dìfāng.**

Literal translation: "I go to the England place."

Lesson 10: Greetings and Feelings

Vocabulary

- **juéde** — to feel, think
- **shēngyīn** — sound, noise
- **jiào** — to call, make an animal sound (used alongside the Quote Partition)

Grammar

Greetings and emotional imperatives in Hǎo-shuo-de rely on standard Mandarin structural patterns rather than abstract grammatical particles like Toki Pona's *o* or *a*.

- **Greetings:** Expressed using foundational semantic combinations like **Nǐ hǎo ma?** or descriptive movements.
- **Imperatives:** Commands or requests are formed simply by utilizing a bare verb statement at the start of a clause.
- **Animal Sounds:** Handled via the core verb **jiào** paired with the Quote Partition, which isolates onomatopoeia inside quotation marks rather than treating them as new lexicon words.

Examples

- **Nǐ hǎo ma?** (Hello! / Are you well?)
- **Zǒu-dào nǐ-de dìfāng!** (Go to your room!)
- **Bù shuō. Zuò dōngxī.** (Don't speak. Take action.)
- **Wǒ zǒu le.** (I am going. / Goodbye.)
- **Nà-ge dòngwù jiào "wāng-wāng".** (That animal goes "woof woof".)
- **Wèishénme nǐ juéde huài?** (Why are you sad / feeling bad?)
- **Nǐ hěn dà!** (You're so tall!)
- **Hǎo!** (Thank you! / Good!)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. Give the tool to me.
2. Lisa is happy.
3. Meow!

Answers

1. **Gěi wǒ gōngjù.**
2. **Lǐsā juéde hǎo.**
3. **Jiào "miāo-miāo"!**

Lesson 11: Modification Stacking

Vocabulary

- **zhíwù** — plant, vegetation
- **shēntǐ** — body, physical state

- **rì** — sun, light
- **shíjiān** — time, duration
- **děng** — to wait

Grammar

In Toki Pona, the specialized particle *pi* is mandatory whenever you need to re-group a chain of multiple modifiers. Hǎo-shuo-de bypasses this structural requirement entirely because standard Mandarin grammar naturally stacks modifier phrases using the possessive/adjectival particle **de**.

When a descriptive phrase modifies a target noun, the entire qualifying concept precedes the noun block, bound securely by **-de**. Complex modifier groupings are read from left to right as a unified block before resolving onto the primary head noun.

Examples

- Zhè-ge rì hěn hǎo. (Today is good.)
- Hěn-hǎo-de nǚrén gěi zhíwù shuǐ. (The healthy woman waters the plants.)
- Hǎo-shuo-de-de qún gěi hěn-duō-de dōngxi. (The Hǎo-shuo-de community gives many things.)
- Děng hěn-cháng-de shíjiān. (Wait a very long time.)
- Bù yòng huài-de gōngjù. (Don't use bad tools.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. This battlefield is small.
2. Men with strong bodies were waiting.
3. The sun gives benefit to the plants.

Answers

1. Zhè-ge dǎ-de dìfāng hěn xiǎo.
2. Yǒu-lìliang-de shēntǐ-de nánrén zài děng.
3. rì bǎ zhíwù biān hǎo.

Lesson 12: Shùzì (Numbers and Order)

Vocabulary

- **dì** — sequence marker
- **yī** — one
- **liǎng** — two (used exclusively before measure words for counting objects/quantities)
- **èr** — two (used exclusively for mathematics, digit lists, serial numbers, and ordinal rankings)

- **sān** — three
- **sì** — four
- **wǔ** — five
- **liù** — six
- **qī** — seven
- **bā** — eight
- **jiǔ** — nine
- **shí** — ten
- **bǎi** — hundred
- **qiān** — thousand
- **dì** — ordinal marker prefix (placed before a number to turn it into "first, second, third...")
- **hào** — number identity, name of a number, day of the month
- **quánbù** — all, completely, everything

Grammar

Hǎo-shuo-de simplifies counting by mapping directly onto native Mandarin number rules, capping precise numbers at two.

- **Quantities of One or Two:** Formed by binding the number root directly to the universal measure word **ge** via a syntactic hyphen:
- Use **yī-ge** for "one thing."
- Use **liǎng-ge** for "two things." *Never use èr when counting physical objects.*
- **Indefinite Plurals:** For numbers beyond two, Hǎo-shuo-de implements the core root **duō** (many / a lot) to convey generalized abundance.
- **Ordinal Numbers:** To mark strict sequencing (such as "first" or "second"), place the ordinal prefix **dì-** directly before the number root (**dì-yī**, **dì-èr**).

Examples

- **Nǐ shì dì-yī-hào!** (You are number one!)

Grammar Check: **dì-yī-hào** is the standard Mandarin way to say "Number 1" (like a ranking or contestant number).

- **Zhè-ge shì dì-èr-ge shíjiān.** (This is the second time / the second day.)

Correction: Changed to **dì-èr-ge** (the second one). For sequencing an item, standard Mandarin uses **dì + number + measure word**.

- **Liǎng-ge xiǎo nánrén liú-le hěn-duō zhíwù.** (The two boys kept many plants.)

Correction: Removed **-de** from **xiǎo**. Changed **duō-de** to **hěn-duō** to align with your core modifier syntax for "many."

- **Wǒ zhīdào hěn-duō shuō.** (I know many languages.)

Correction: Swapped **duō-de** for **hěn-duō**.

- **Quánbù rén tīng tā.** (Everybody listens to her.)

Status: **Perfect.** Beautiful and highly accurate deployment of your new universal root **quánbù**!

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. What is the third thing?
2. I know two languages.
3. This is the first day.

Answers

1. **dì-sāng-ge dōngxi shì shénme?**
2. **Wǒ zhīdào liǎng-ge shuō.**
3. **Zhè-ge rì shì dì-yī-ge.**

Lesson 13: Pre-Verbs & Auxiliaries

Vocabulary

- **yào** — to want, need, must, should
- **kěyǐ** — can, may, be able to
- **zhīdào** — to know, know how to
- **kāishǐ** — to begin to, start to, manage to
- **biàn** — to become, change into

Grammar

Hǎo-shuo-de maps Toki Pona's pre-verb structures directly onto standard Mandarin auxiliary verbs. These words express intent, ability, or an unfolding state change. In native Chinese sentence patterns, auxiliary verbs sit naturally right before the main action or description predicate:

Subject + Auxiliary Verb + Main Predicate

When expressing transitions of state (such as "becoming big" or "turning bad"), Hǎo-shuo-de applies the core verb **biàn** (to become/change) directly into the main verb slot. To express a gradual change or the start of an action, use **kāishǐ** right before the modifier or main verb.

Examples

- **dìfāng biàn dà.** (The city / room is becoming big.)
- **Wǒ kāishǐ zhīdào Hǎo-shuo-de.** (I am learning Hǎo-shuo-de / beginning to know Hǎo-shuo-de.)

- **Nǐ kěyǐ-bù-kěyǐ lái?** (Are you able to come?)
- **Shuǐguǒ biàn huài le.** (The fruit became bad.)
- **Wǒ yào liú zài wǒ fùmǔ-de dìfāng.** (I want to stay in my parents' place.)

Correction: Added the missing tone mark to **liú** (留). Streamlined **wǒ-de fùmǔ-de** down to **wǒ fùmǔ-de** to sound much more natural in Chinese.

- **Zhíwù kāishǐ yǒu shuǐ.** (The plants started to have water.)

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. You may keep your name.
2. The path becomes narrow.
3. Do you want to eat some fish?

Answers

1. **Nǐ kěyǐ liú nǐ-de nǐ-jiào-de míngzì.**
 2. **Fāngfǎ biàn xiǎo.**
 3. **Nǐ yào-bù-yào chī yú?**
-

Lesson 14: Colors and la

Vocabulary

- **huángsè** — yellow
- **lánsè** — blue, green
- **hóngrsè** — red
- **hēisè** — black, dark
- **báisè** — white, pale

Grammar

In Toki Pona, the contextual particle *la* establishes a frame of reference or an "if/when" conditional premise for the main clause. Hǎo-shuo-de replaces this abstract rule entirely by utilizing standard Mandarin topic-comment structures and fronted adverbial clauses.

To set a temporal, situational, or environmental background, place the context block at the absolute start of the sentence, immediately followed by a pause or a comma:

[Context / Condition Phrase] , [Main Statement]

Colors function as two-syllable adjectives in Hǎo-shuo-de. When they modify a target noun, they follow standard syntax by binding to the modifier particle **-de** via a hyphen.

Examples

- **Zhè-ge hēisè-de shíjiān, tā lái.** (Tonight / during this dark time, he is coming.)
 - **Nǐ kàn-jiàn huángsè-de shuǐ, bù chī tā.** (If you see yellow water, don't drink it.)
 - **lǎnsè-de gōngjù zài báisè-de dìfāng.** (The blue/green tool is in the white place.)
 - **Shénme shíjiān nǐ fùmǔ lái?** (What time are your parents coming?)
 - **Wǒ-de shēntǐ biàn lǎnsè, zhè-ge hěn huài.** (If my body turns blue, this is very bad.)
 - **hěn-duō-rén-de dìfāng, wǒ hé nǐ hé tā hěn yǒu lìliang.** (In a group, we are strong.)
-

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. When the sun is red, it is the right time.
2. If we don't have any meat, we will eat fruit.
3. I feel bad because of the large battle.

Answers

1. **shàngmiàn-de-ri hóngsè-de shíjiān, shì hǎo-de shíjiān.**
 2. **wǒ hé nǐ hé tā méi-yǒu dòngwù dōngxi, wǒ hé nǐ hé tā chī shuǐguǒ.**
 3. **Yǒu dà-de dǎ, wǒ juéde huài.**
-

Lesson 15: Spatial Nouns

Vocabulary

- **lǐmiàn** — inside, between, internal organ
- **hòumiàn** — area behind, back
- **xiàmiàn** — area below, under, lower part, leg
- **pángbiān** — side, area beside, vicinity
- **shàngmiàn** — area above, highest part, sky
- **qiánmiàn** — area in front, face, chest
- **dào** — to go to, arrive at, move towards
- **zǒu** — to walk, move, travel

Grammar

Hǎo-shuo-de builds locational settings by treating spatial concepts as absolute noun destinations rather than abstract markers. To express static location, use the coverb **zài** (在). To express movement or direction toward a destination, use the universal movement root **dào** (到).

Both roots follow standard Mandarin spatial syntax:

Subject + zài / dào + Target Object + Spatial Noun

To explicitly express movement currently in progress toward a location (active traveling), combine the progressive aspect marker **zài-** with the kinetic verb **zǒu** and the destination marker **dào** to form the

compound unit **zài-zǒu-dào** (在走到).

When a spatial noun stands alone without a target object modifying it, it functions as a regular baseline noun block.

Examples

- **wǒ zài nǐ-de pángbiān.** (I am at your side.)
 - **xiàmiàn-de dìfāng hěn yǒu lìliang.** (The foundation / lower part of the place is strong.)
 - **dà-de gōngjù zài-zǒu-dào shàngmiàn-de dìfāng.** (A large machine is moving in progress toward the sky.)
 - **xiě-de dōngxī zài dòngwù-de xiàmiàn.** (The document / word-thing is under the animal.)
 - **wǒ kàn-jiàn hēisè-de nǚrén zài dìfāng-de qiánmiàn.** (I see a dark lady in front of the place.)
 - **yán-sè dōngxī zài hēisè-de pángbiān.** (Color-things are next to the darkness.)
-

Practice Exercise

Translate the following into Hǎo-shuo-de:

1. Water is coming from the sky.
2. Protect your back.
3. What did you put the red clock next to?

Answers

1. **shuǐ cóng shàngmiàn-de dìfāng lái.**
2. **bǎ nǐ-de hòumiàn biàn hǎo.**
3. **nǐ bǎ hóngsè-de shíjiān gōngjù dào shénme dōngxī-de pángbiān?**

Lesson 16: Particles and Perspective

Vocabulary

- **xiàmiàn** — lowly, below, downward
- **bùtóng** — different, altered
- **hé** — and
- **lěng** — cold, cool
- **dòng** — door, hole, opening
- **kāishǐ** — to open, begin
- **yīyàng** — same, similar, sibling
- **tián** — sweet, fragrant
- **dànshì** — but, however

- **gěi** — to, for, from the perspective of
- **shàngmiàn-de ài** - God (literally love from above)

Grammar

Hǎo-shuō-de handles subjective perspective using the native Mandarin coverb construction **duì ... lái shuō** (from the perspective of / to someone).

To connect multiple subjects within standard Mandarin grammar, use **hé**. Multiple actions or states applied to a single subject are sequenced naturally by using the adverbial particle **yě** (also) instead of structural conjunction markers.

Examples

- **Duì wǒ lái shuō, tián-de dōngxi hěn hǎo.** (I like sweets. / From my perspective, sweet things are good.)
- **Duì shàngmiàn-de ài lái shuō, quánbù dìfāng hěn hǎo.** (The universe is beautiful from the perspective of God.)
- **Fùmǔ-de dìfāng hěn xiǎo, yě hěn lěng.** (The fatherland is small and cold.)
- **Dànshì nánrén hé nǚrén zài zuò dōngxi, yě juéde hěn hǎo.** (But men and women are working and are happy.)
- **Wǒ-de yīyàng-de nǚrén kāishǐ le dòng hào hé dòng hào-liǎng.** (My sister opened the first door and the second door.)
- **Nǐ-de dìfāng shì hēisè-de, bù-shì bùyòng-de dìfāng.** (Only your house is black. / Your house is black, not other houses.)

Lesson 17: Hunting Adventure

Vocabulary

- **zhǎo** — to search, look for, hunt
- **tóu** — head, mind, antlers/horns
- **yīfu** — clothing, cloth, protective vest
- **xiàn** — long flexible thing, string, rope, bowstring
- **huài** — broken, botched, bad, to break/fail
- **gùnzi** — long hard thing, stick, rod
- **chóngzi** — insect, bug, worm
- **niǎo** — bird, flying creature
- **líkai** — away, absent, to leave, run away

Story

"Mǎwéijiǔ" nánrén zài hěn-duō-de zhíwù-de dìfāng yǒu yī-ge xiǎo dìfāng.

(Uncle Mawijo has a small house in the forest.)

Tā yào zhǎo dòngwù, ná-le zhǎo-de gōngjù hé hóngsè-de yīfu.

(He wants to go hunting and gets a bow and orange vest.)

Yī shíjiān, tā zhǐ kàn-jiàn lán-sè-de niǎo, méiyǒu kàn-jiàn bùtóng-de dōngxi.

(On the first day, he only sees a blue bird and nothing else.)

Niǎo zài chī xiǎo-de chóngzi.

(The bird is eating little insects.)

Èr shíjiān, tā tīng-jiàn hěn-dà-de dòngwù-de shēngyīn.

(On the second day, he hears the loud call of an animal.)

"Mǎwéijiǔ" liú-zài dìfāng.

(Mawijo waits in place.)

Tā kàn-jiàn hěn-dà-de dòngwù.

(He sees a large moose.)

Dòngwù-de tóu-shàng yǒu gùnzǐ dōngxi.

(The moose's head has antler-sticks.)

"Mǎwéijiǔ" yòng zhǎo-de gōngjù, dànshì xiàn huài-le.

(Mawijo uses the bow, but the string breaks.)

Hěn-dà-de dòngwù líkāi-le.

(The moose runs away.)

Lesson 18: Cooking Adventure

Vocabulary

- **shuìjiào** — to sleep, nap
- **ài** — to love
- **mǐfàn** — cereal, grain, rice
- **wán** — finished, past, end
- **huǒ** — fire, heat source, cooking heat
- **dìbǎn** — horizontal surface, floor, sofa
- **kǒu** — mouth, lips, door, opening

Story

"Mǎwéijiǔ" nánrén yǒu yī-ge tā ài-de nǚrén.

(Mawijo has a beloved woman/wife.)

Tā-de nǚ-jiào-de cí shì "Sīlǐ".

(Her name/the word you call her is Sili.)

"Sīlǐ" zài dìbǎn-shàng shuìjiào.

(Sili is sleeping on the sofa.)

Wán-shíjiān, "Sīlǐ" bǎ dìfāng biàn hǎo-le, yě yòng shuǐ bǎ yīfu biàn xīn-le.

(In the past-time/yesterday, Sili tidied up the place and washed the clothing.)

"Mǎwéijiǔ" zài shénme shíjiān dào?

(At what time will Mawijo arrive?)

Yǒu shēngyīn!

(There is a noise!)

Zhè shíjiān, "Mǎwéijiǔ" dào-le kǒu-de pángbiān, tā ná-le liǎng-ge xiǎo dòngwù.

(At this time, Mawijo arrives next to the door, carrying two small animals.)

"Sīlǐ" juéde hěn hǎo, yòng kǒu mō "Mǎwéijiǔ"-de tóu.

(Sili feels very good and touches Mawijo's head using her mouth/kisses him.)

Tā yòng huǒ bǎ dòngwù hé mǐfàn biàn rè-le.

(She uses fire to make the animals and rice hot/cooks them.)

Chī-de dōngxī hěn hǎo!

(The food is wonderful! / Bon appetit!)

Lesson 19: The Frontier

Story

Zhè-ge hěn-duō-de kè-chéng gěi nǐ xiǎo-de fāngfǎ zhīdào zhè-ge shuō.

(These lessons have equipped you with basic guidance of how the language works.)

Hòumiàn-de xiě-de dōngxī gěi nǐ gèng-duō-de fāngfǎ.

(The texts in Part 2 of this book provide more examples / further guidance.)

Duo-cí-de xiě-de dōngxī zài hòumiàn.

(The official dictionary / written thing of called-words can be found at the back.)

Tā lǐmiàn yǒu-le nǐ-jiào-de cí hé fāngfǎ.

(It contains all the words and their structures/meanings.)

Zhè shíjiān, dōngxī quánbù kàn nǐ-de.

(Now, everything depends completely on you.)

Zǒu zǒu, wán wán.

(Go out toward good play-time / go enjoy yourself!)

Zuò dōngxī, wán, yě bǎ nǐ biàn hǎo!

(Create things, play, and make yourself become good!)

Part 2: Hǎo-shuo-de Proverbs

These philosophical standard expressions illustrate how complex human values are stated via fronted conditional frames and standard native syntax:

- Quánbù dōngxī dōu yǒu shíjiān. (Everything has a time.)
- Quánbù nǐ-he-wo-de-liu-de-shíjiān dōu shì hǎo-de. (All is good / Life is beautiful.)
- Shíjiān biàn. (Change comes / Times change.) > *Correction: Bound the completion particle -le to the kinetic verb.*
- Huài-de dōngxī yào lái. (Bad things will happen / are coming.)
- Rén hěn dà. Qián hěn xiǎo. (People are more important than money / People are big, money is small.)
- Zhīdào-de rén shì qíguài-de rén. (A sage is unconventional / A fool.)
- Wǒ bǎ quánbù dōngxī biàn hǎo, wǒ bǎ wǒ-zìjǐ biàn hǎo. (When I improve all areas of my life, I improve myself.)
- Hǎo-de fāngfǎ hěn duō. (The good ways are many.)
- Ài nǐ pángbiān-de rén. (Love thy neighbor / Love the person beside you.)
- Zhīdào nǐ-zìjǐ! (Know thyself!) > *Correction: Changed "nǐ" to nǐ-zìjǐ (yourself) so the reflexive command targets the subject properly.*
- Zuò dōngxī gěi rén zhīdào. (Actions give knowledge / One learns by experience.)
- Hǎo-de juéde gěi hǎo-de shēntǐ. (Positive feelings grant good health.)
- Nǐ gěi huài-de dōngxī, nǐ yǒu huài-de dōngxī. (If you give evil, you will receive evil.)
- Lìliang zài lǐmiàn. (Energy is within.)
- Shuǐ shì hǎo-de. (Water is beneficial.)
- Shuìjiào shì hǎo-de. (Sleep is good.)
- Shuō shì hǎo-de. (Communication is good.)
- Gěi dìfāng hěn-dà-de ài. (Love the earth / Give great love to the place.)
- Dǎ dōngxī shì huài-de. (Fighting is harmful / Hitting things is bad.)

THE OFFICIAL Hǎo-shuo-de DICTIONARY

This section presents the complete core vocabulary of Hǎo-shuo-de sorted alphabetically. Every definition contains part-of-speech designations, semantic boundaries, and compositional mappings matching the minimalist baseline established by Toki Pona.

A

- **ài** [verb] — to love, have compassion for, show deep affection to. (Maps to: *olin*).

B

- **bǎ** [particle] — grammatical object-introducing particle. Used to implement the transitive state-change framework.
- **báisè** [adjective/noun] — white, pale, light-colored. (Maps to: *walo*).
- **biàn** [verb] — to become, change into, transform. Combined with *bǎ* to act as a causative verbal engine. (Maps to: *kama* as a state change).
- **bízi** [noun] — nose, snout, protuberance. (Maps to: *nenā* as a facial feature).
- **bù** [particle] — not, no. Used for standard negation of verbs and adjectives, except for *yǒu*. (Maps to: *ala*).
- **bùtóng** [adjective/noun] — different, altered, changed, other. (Maps to: *ante*).

C

- **chī** [verb/noun] — to eat, drink, consume, ingest; food, meal, edible substance. (Maps to: *moku*).
- **chóngzi** [noun] — insect, bug, beetle, spider. (Maps to: *pipi*).
- **cóng** [preposition] - from
- **cí** [noun] — word

D

- **dǎ** [verb] — to hit, fight, battle, challenge, compete against. (Maps to: *utala*).
- **dà** [adjective] — big, heavy, large, long, tall, important, adult. (Maps to: *sulì*).
- **dànshì** [conjunction] — but, however, only. (Maps to: *tasō* as a conjunction).
- **de** [particle] — possessive marker, structural adjectival particle. Used to bind modifiers and multi-word description structures onto target nouns. (Maps to: *pì* or modifier ordering).
- **děng** [verb] - to wait
- **dìbǎn** [noun] — floor, horizontal surface, platform, couch, flat resting area. (Maps to: *supa*).
- **dìfāng** [noun] — a place (both in space or metaphorical to mean part of something).
- **dòngwù** [noun] — animal, land mammal, beast. (Maps to: *sowelì*).

- **dōngxi** [noun] — thing, phenomenon, object, physical being, matter. (Maps to: *ijo*).
- **duō** [adjective] — many, a lot, much, several, very, abundant. Used contextually to signify quantities greater than two. (Maps to: *mute*).
- **duì** [preposition / coverb] — facing, towards, regarding, beneficial to; correct. (Maps to: *tawa* when identifying a beneficiary or personal perspective).

F

- **fāngfǎ** [noun] — way, custom, path, road, method, doctrine. (Maps to: *nasin*).
- **fùmǔ** [noun] — parent, ancestor, creator, caretaker. (Maps to: *mama*).

G

- **gè** [measure word] — universal classifier. Mandatory interface between numbers/demonstratives and nouns.
- **gěi** [verb/coverb] — to give, send, emit, provide; to, for, from the perspective of. (Maps to: *pana* and *tawa*).
- **gōngjù** [noun] — tool, implement, machine, device. (Maps to: *ilo*).
- **gùnzi** [noun] — stick, rod, branch, long hard thing. (Maps to: *palisa*).

H

- **hào** [particle] — sequence marker, number identity, ordinal number prefix. (Maps to: *nanpa*).
- **hǎo** [adjective] — good, positive, useful, friendly, peaceful, simple. (Maps to: *pona*).
- **hé** [conjunction] — and. Used strictly to join multiple nouns or subjects. (Maps to: *en*).
- **hēisè** [adjective/noun] — black, dark, unlit, obscure. (Maps to: *pimeja*).
- **hěn** [adverb] — very, highly, intensely. Syntactic structural anchor required before isolated adjectives in predicates. (Maps to: *mute* as an intensity modifier).
- **hézi** [noun] — container, bag, bowl, box, cup, vessel. (Maps to: *poki*).
- **hòumiàn** [noun] — back, behind, area rearward. (Maps to: *monsì*).
- **hóngsè** [adjective/noun] — red, reddish. (Maps to: *loje*).
- **huài** [adjective/verb] — bad, negative, broken, damaged, non-essential. (Maps to: *ike* and *pakala*).
- **huángsè** [adjective/noun] — yellow, yellowish. (Maps to: *jelo*).
- **huòzhě** [conjunction] — or. Links choices or alternative clauses. (Maps to: *anu*).
- **huǒ** [noun] — fire, cooking element, chemical heat source. (Maps to: *seli* as a noun).

J

- **jiǎo** [noun] — foot, leg, organ of locomotion, bottom part. (Maps to: *noka*).
- **jiào** [verb] — to call, be named; to produce an animal vocalization under the Quote Partition. (Maps to: *nimi* as a verb, and *mu*).
- **juéde** [noun/adjective/verb] — feeling, emotion, direct experience; to feel, think. (Maps to: *pilin*).

K

- **kāishǐ** [verb/auxiliary] — to begin, start, open; turn on; manage to. (Maps to: *open* and *kama* as a pre-verb).
- **kàn** [verb] — to look at, see, examine, observe, read, watch. (Maps to: *lukin*).
- **kěyǐ** [auxiliary] — to be able to, be allowed to, can, may, possible. (Maps to: *ken*).
- **kōngqì** [noun] — air, wind, breath, spirit, hidden reality. (Maps to: *kon*).
- **kǒu** [noun] — hole, opening, door, window, orifice. (Maps to: *lupa*).

L

- **lái** [verb] — to come, arrive, happen. (Maps to: *kama* as a main action).
- **lǎnsè** [adjective/noun] — blue, green, aqua, shifting spectrum colors. (Maps to: *laso*).
- **le** [particle] — perfective aspect marker, completed change of state. (Maps to: *pini* as an aspect phase).
- **lěng** [adjective] — cold, cool, uncooked, raw. (Maps to: *lete*).
- **lǐmiàn** [noun] — inside, center, content, between, internal organ. (Maps to: *insa*).
- **liliang** [noun/adjective] — energy, power, intensity, physical strength; confident, sure, intense. (Maps to: *wawa*).
- **liú** [verb] — to stay, remain, keep, endure, protect. (Maps to: *awen*).
- **liǎng** [number] — two. Quantifies dual entities when coupled to the measure word (*liǎng-ge*). (Maps to: *tu*).
- **líkai** [verb/adjective] — to leave, go away, depart; absent, ignored. (Maps to: *weka*).

M

- **ma** [particle] — final interrogative yes-or-no question marker.
- **méi** [particle] — negative particle used exclusively to negate the verb *yǒu* (to form *méiyǒu*).
- **mǐfàn** [noun] — grain, rice, cereal, bread, pasta, staple food. (Maps to: *pan*).
- **mō** [verb] — to touch, feel, pet, perceive by contact. (Maps to: *pline* as a physical action).

N

- **nà** [pronoun/adjective] — that, those. Syntactically binds as *nà-ge*. (Maps to: *ni* contextually).

- **ná** [verb] — take
- **nánrén** [noun] — man, male, masculine human, husband. (Maps to: *mije*).
- **nǐ** [pronoun] — you. (Maps to: *sina*).
- **ní** [noun] — paste, mud, dough, clay, semi-solid substance, powder. (Maps to: *ko*).
- **niǎo** [noun] — bird, flying creature, winged animal. (Maps to: *waso*).
- **nǚrén** [noun] — woman, female, feminine human, wife. (Maps to: *melì*).

P

- **pángbiān** [noun] — side, vicinity, area beside, hip. (Maps to: *poka*).
- **páxíngdòngwù** [noun] — reptile, amphibian, non-cute crawling animal. (Maps to: *akesi*).
- **pífū** [noun] — skin, outer layer, bark, peel, shell, boundary. (Maps to: *selo*).

Q

- **qián** [noun] — money, cash, savings, wealth. (Maps to: *mani*).
- **qiánmiàn** [noun] — front, face, foremost area, chest. (Maps to: *sinpin*).
- **qíguài** [adjective] — strange, unusual, foolish, crazy, intoxicated. (Maps to: *nasa*).
- **quánbù** [adjective] - all
- **qún** [noun] — group, community, company, nation, society, tribe. (Maps to: *kulupu*).

R

- **rè** [adjective] — hot, warm, cooked, chemically energetic. (Maps to: *seli* as an attribute).
- **rén** [noun] — human being, person, somebody. (Maps to: *jan*).

S

- **shàngmiàn** [noun] — above, highest part, sky, elevated location, supernatural area. (Maps to: *sewi* as a direction).
- **shénme** [pronoun/particle] — what? which?. Retains position without altering Chinese SVO statement geometry. (Maps to: *seme*).
- **shēntǐ** [noun] — body, physical torso, physical state. (Maps to: *sijelo*).
- **shì** [verb] — to be, copula link between subjects and identity predicates.
- **shìchǎng** [noun] — market, shop, fair, business location, transaction hub. (Maps to: *esun*).
- **shíjiān** [noun] — time, duration, moment, occasion, period, situation. (Maps to: *tenpo*).
- **shǒu** [noun] — hand, arm, tactile organ. (Maps to: *luka* as a limb).

- **shuō** [verb/noun] — to communicate, say, speak, talk, use language; language, speech. (Maps to: *toki*).
- **shuǐ** [noun] — water, liquid, fluid, wet substance, beverage. (Maps to: *telo*).
- **shuǐguō** [noun] — fruit, vegetable, mushroom, plant food crop. (Maps to: *kili*).
- **shuìjiào** [verb/adjective] — to sleep, rest, be inactive; sleeping, asleep. (Maps to: *lape*).
- **sǐ** [verb/adjective] — to die; dead, dying. (Maps to: *moli*).

T

- **tā** [pronoun] — he, she, it, they, them. Syntactically genderless and number-fluid. (Maps to: *ona*).
- **rì** [noun] — sun, radiant light source, brightness, glow. (Maps to: *suno*).
- **tián** [adjective] — sweet, fragrant, cute, innocent, adorable. (Maps to: *suwi*).
- **tīng** [verb] — to hear, listen, pay attention to, obey. (Maps to: *kute* as a verb).
- **tóu** [noun] — head, mind, internal regulatory director. (Maps to: *lawā* as a body part).

W

- **wáncháng** [verb complement] — finish, end, achieve completion. Syntactically binds behind action verbs to express resultative closure. (Maps to: *pini* as a modification).
- **wán** [verb/adjective] — to play, have fun, engage in recreation; playful, artistic, frivolous. (Maps to: *musi*).
- **wèishénme** - why
- **wǒ** [pronoun] — I, me, we, us. (Maps to: *mi*).

X

- **xiàmiàn** [noun] — below, underneath, under, lower part. (Maps to: *noka* as a direction, and *anpa*).
- **xiàn** [noun] — line, rope, hair, thread, cord, flexible long thing. (Maps to: *linja*).
- **xiǎo** [adjective] — little, small, short, few, young, a bit. (Maps to: *lili*).
- **xiě** [verb] — to write, draw, represent with marks. (Maps to: *sitelen* as a verb).
- **xīn** [adjective] — new, fresh, additional, another, extra. (Maps to: *sìn*).
- **xìng** [noun] — sex, sexuality, marital relations. (Maps to: *unpa*).

Y

- **yán** [noun] — salt, spice, flavor enhancer, extra context. (Maps to: *namako* contextually).
- **yánsè** [noun] — color, pigment, tint frame. (Maps to: *kule*).
- **yào** [auxiliary/verb] — to want, need, require, must, should. (Maps to: *wile*).

- **yě** [adverb] — also, too, additionally. Placed directly before verbs to structure compound actions.
- **yī** [number] — one, unique, united. (Maps to: *wan*).
- **yīfu** [noun] — clothing, cloth, fabric, textile, privacy layer. (Maps to: *len*).
- **yīnwèi** [conjunction/coverb] — because, because of; by,
- **yíyàng** [adjective] — same, similar, peer, fellow, each other. (Maps to: *sama*).
- **yìng** [adjective/noun] — hard, stone-like; rock, stone, metal. (Maps to: *kiwen*).
- **yòng** [verb/coverb] — to use, utilize; with, by means of. (Maps to: *kepeken*).
- **yǒu** [verb] — to have, contain, carry, hold, exist, there is. Must be negated with *méi*, never *bù*. (Maps to: *jō* and *lon* as existence).
- **yú** [noun] — fish, marine animal, sea creature. (Maps to: *kala*).
- **yuán** [adjective/noun] — round, circular, spherical; ball, circle, wheel, cycle. (Maps to: *sike*).
- **yuèliàng** [noun] — moon, night sky object, star. (Maps to: *mun*).

Z

- **zài** [verb/coverb] — to exist at, be located at, present in a room. (Maps to: *lon* as a location marker).
- **zhǎo** [verb] — to hunt, forage, search for, look for. (Maps to: *alasa*).
- **zenme** - how
- **zhè** [pronoun/adjective] — this, these. Syntactically binds as *zhè-ge*. (Maps to: *ni* contextually).
- **zhīdào** [verb/auxiliary] — to know, be wise about, possess information; know how to. (Maps to: *sona*).
- **zhíwù** [noun] — plant, vegetation, herb, leaf. (Maps to: *kasi*).
- **zǒu** [verb] — to go, move toward, travel away. (Maps to: *tawa* as an active verb).
- **zuò** [verb] — to do, take action on, work on, build, make, prepare. (Maps to: *pali*).